Master Glossary of Buddhist Terms

Taishō Tripiṭaka Translation Project

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Master Glossary of Buddhist Terms

This glossary contains 610 terms compiled from published BDK English Tripiṭaka glossaries (213 entries) and our own Taishō translations (397 entries). Each entry lists the English rendering, Chinese original, Sanskrit or Pali equivalent (where known), and source.

Doctrinal Terms (219 entries)

Abhidharma (阿毘達磨): A collection of treatises explaining some of the contents of the Buddha's teachings. One of the three divisions (Tripitaka) of Buddhist scriptures. The other two are the Sutra (the sermons of the Buddha) and the Vinaya (rules of monastic discipline). [BDK BDK T0676]

acarya: Teacher. [BDK BDK T0203]

afflicted mentation (末那識) Skt. *kliṣṭa-manas*

afflictions (煩惱) Skt. *kleśa*

agama: Early Buddhist texts, most of which are extant only in Chinese translation; they correspond to the Pali nikayas. [BDK BDK T0203]

aging and death (老死) Skt. *jarāmaraṇa*

anger (瞋) Skt. *dveṣa*

anuttara samyaksambodhi: Complete, perfect enlightenment. [BDK BDK T0262]

anuttarā-samyak-saṃbodhi (阿耨多羅三藐三菩提)

anāgāmin (阿那含)

applied thought (尋) Skt. *vitarka*

aranyaka conduct Skt. *aranyaka*: Dwelling in the forest. [BDK BDK T0203]

arrogance (憍) Skt. *mada*

asamkhya/asamkhyeya: ”Incalculable”; a very high number. [BDK BDK T0159]

asoka: A kind of flower. [BDK BDK T0203]

avadana: Story, parable; one of the twelve types of scriptures. [BDK BDK T0203]

avadāna (譬喻)

becoming (有) Skt. *bhava*

bhiksuni: A Buddhist nun. [BDK BDK T0203]

birth (生) Skt. *jāti*

bodhi (菩提): Awakening; enlightenment. [BDK BDK T0203]

bodhi-mind Skt. *bodhicitta*: Lit., the mind (citta) of awakening or enlightenment (bodhi). The aspiration for enlightenment. [BDK BDK T0159]

body-consciousness (身識) Skt. *kāya-vijñāna*

buddha eye (佛眼) Skt. *buddhacakṣus*

candala: An outcaste; a violent person, a butcher. [BDK BDK T0203]

candra: Moon, splendor. [BDK BDK T0203]

cessation of perception and feeling (滅盡定) Skt. *nirodha-samāpatti*

clinging to rules and observances (戒禁取) Skt. *śīla-vrata-parāmarśa*

clinging to views (見取) Skt. *dṛṣṭi-parāmarśa*

conceit (慢) Skt. *māna*

conceptual proliferation (戲論) Skt. *prapañca*

conditioned phenomena (有為法) Skt. *saṃskṛta-dharma*

consciousness (識) Skt. *vijñāna*

contact (觸) Skt. *sparśa*

conventional designation (假名) Skt. *prajñapti*

conventional truth (世俗諦) Skt. *saṃvṛti-satya*

craving (愛) Skt. *tṛṣṇā*

danapati: Patron, almsgiver, donor. [BDK BDK T0203]

deceit (誑) Skt. *māyā*

decorum (愧) Skt. *apatrāpya*

delusion (癡) Skt. *moha*

dependent arising (緣起) Skt. *pratītyasamutpāda*

dependent co-arising: The doctrine that all things come into being only in dependence upon other things. [BDK BDK T0676]

dependent origination Skt. *pratityasamutpada*: The Buddhist doctrine which holds that all phenomena (dharmas) arise in relation to causes and conditions and in turn are the causes and conditions for the arising of other phenomena. Nothing exists independently of its causes and conditions. [BDK BDK T0262]

dharani: Mnemonic device or formula; also, spell or incantation. [BDK BDK T0159]

dharma (法): An individually existing thing. [BDK BDK T0203]

dharma eye (法眼) Skt. *dharmacakṣus*

Dharmapada: A work corresponding to the Pali Dhammapada. [BDK BDK T0203]

distraction (散亂) Skt. *vikṣepa*

divine eye (天眼) Skt. *divyacakṣus*

doubt (疑) Skt. *vicikitsā*

drowsiness (睡眠) Skt. *middha*

ear-consciousness (耳識) Skt. *śrotra-vijñāna*

eight perils: See eight great fears. [BDK BDK T0159]

eight worldly conditions (八風) Skt. *aṣṭalokadharma*

eighteen unique dharmas (十八不共法) Skt. *aṣṭādaśa āveṇika-buddhadharma*

emptiness (空) Skt. *śūnyatā*: The quality that all things have of being devoid of independent, real existence. Emptiness is emptiness of svabhava, which is independent being, autonomy, self-nature, etc. The central teaching of Mahayana Buddhism. [BDK BDK T0676]

enmity (恨) Skt. *upanāha*

extreme view (邊見) Skt. *antagrāha-dṛṣṭi*

eye-consciousness (眼識) Skt. *cakṣur-vijñāna*

feeling (受) Skt. *vedanā*

five aggregates (五蘊) Skt. *pañcaskandha*: The five aggregates that make up sentient beings: (1) form (rupa), (2) sensation (vedana), (3) conception (samjna), (4) volition (samskara), and (5) consciousness (vijnana). [BDK BDK T0676]

five aggregates of clinging (五取蘊) Skt. *pañcopādānaskandha*

five eyes (五眼) Skt. *pañcacakṣus*

five hindrances (五蓋) Skt. *pañcanīvaraṇa*

five supernormal faculties Skt. *pancabhijna*: Five supernormal powers: (1) supernormal vision, (2) supernormal hearing, (3) the ability to know others' thoughts, (4) the ability to know former lives, and (5) the ability to perform miracles such as appearing anywhere at will. [BDK BDK T0159]

forgetfulness (失念) Skt. *muṣita-smṛtitā*

form (色) Skt. *rūpa*

formations (行) Skt. *saṃskāra*

four fearlessnesses (四無畏) Skt. *catvāri vaiśāradyāni*

four modes of birth: According to Buddhism, the four possible ways that a being may be born, i.e., 1) from a womb, 2) from an egg, 3) from moisture, or 4) through metamorphosis or spontaneous generation. [BDK BDK T0262]

four noble truths (四聖諦) Skt. *catvāri āryasatyāni*: (1) Life is suffering; (2) our attachments are the cause of suffering; (3) all suffering can be ended; (4) the way to end suffering is by following the Buddha's eight-fold right path (i.e., right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right concentration). [BDK BDK T0211]

garuda: A mythological giant bird. [BDK BDK T0676]

gatha: A scriptural stanza. [BDK BDK T0203]

geyas (應頌) Skt. *geya*

grasping (取) Skt. *upādāna*

greed (貪) Skt. *rāga*

guile (諂) Skt. *śāṭhya*

gāthā (偈)

harmfulness (害) Skt. *vihiṃsā*

Hīnayāna (小乘)

ignorance (無明) Skt. *avidyā*

ill will (瞋恚) Skt. *vyāpāda*

impermanence (無常) Skt. *anitya*

jambu: A type of tree; its fruit; a rose apple. [BDK BDK T0203]

jealousy (嫉) Skt. *īrṣyā*

jātaka (本生)

kambala: A wool garment. [BDK BDK T0203]

karma (業): Action that results in recompense or retribution; willed action; moral action. [BDK BDK T0203]

karmadana: Giver of work, i.e., assigner of duties (in a monastery). [BDK BDK T0203]

karmic consequences (業報) Skt. *karmavipāka*

khadira: A kind of acacia tree; its wood. [BDK BDK T0203]

kimnara: A class of mythical beings, either half bird or half human and half horse, who make celestial music. [BDK BDK T0676]

koti: A high number, a crore. [BDK BDK T0159]

krkara: A kind of partridge. [BDK BDK T0203]

krosa: A distance; earshot. [BDK BDK T0203]

krtya: A class of evil beings, sorcerers. [BDK BDK T0262]

ksatriya: A member of the military or ruling class, the second of the four castes. [BDK BDK T0159]

kumuda: A kind of water lily. [BDK BDK T0203]

laziness (懈怠) Skt. *kausīdya*

li: A distance; somewhat more than one-third of a mile. [BDK BDK T0203]

liberation (解脫) Skt. *vimukti*

liberation of mind (心解脫) Skt. *cetovimutti*

Madhyamaka (中觀)

Mahacina: Great China; China. [BDK BDK T0203]

mahoraga: A class of snake-like mythical beings. [BDK BDK T0676]

Mahāyāna (大乘)

malla: An athlete. [BDK BDK T0203]

manusyakrtya: A class of human sorcerers. [BDK BDK T0262]

mental consciousness (意識) Skt. *mano-vijñāna*

mentation (意) Skt. *manas*

Middle Way (中道) Skt. *madhyamā-pratipad*

miserliness (慳) Skt. *mātsarya*

mudra: A ritual hand gesture. [BDK BDK T0159]

naga: A serpent deity, a dragon. [BDK BDK T0676]

name-and-form (名色) Skt. *nāmarūpa*

Narayana: Visnu. [BDK BDK T0203]

nayuta: A large unit of numerical measurement, said to be equal to ten million or one hundred billion. [BDK BDK T0262]

nidāna (因緣)

nine abodes of beings (九有情居) Skt. *navasattāvāsa*

Nirgrantha: A Jain. [BDK BDK T0203]

nirvāṇa (涅槃)

non-harmfulness (不害) Skt. *ahiṃsā*

non-self (無我) Skt. *anātman*

nose-consciousness (鼻識) Skt. *ghrāṇa-vijñāna*

nyagrodha: A type of Indian fig tree. [BDK BDK T0203]

once-return (斯陀含) Skt. *sakṛdāgāmin*

padma: A red lotus. [BDK BDK T0203]

pancavarsika: Great quinquennial assembly. [BDK BDK T0203]

Papiyan: Wicked (epithet of Mara). [BDK BDK T0203]

parinirvana: Complete nirvana. [BDK BDK T0262]

parinirvāṇa (般涅槃)

perception (想) Skt. *saṃjñā*

prajñā (般若)

prajñāpāramitā (般若波羅蜜多)

pundarika: A white lotus. [BDK BDK T0203]

regret (惡作) Skt. *kaukṛtya*

restlessness (掉舉) Skt. *auddhatya*

restlessness-and-remorse (掉舉惡作) Skt. *auddhatya-kaukṛtya*

right view (正見) Skt. *samyag-dṛṣṭi*

Sakra: Indra; the lord of the gods (so-called, but below Brahma). [BDK BDK T0203]

sambodhi: Complete awakening. [BDK BDK T0203]

sangha: The Buddhist order, the monastic community. [BDK BDK T0203]

Sarvastivada: A certain school of Buddhism. [BDK BDK T0203]

saṃgha (僧伽)

seeds (種子) Skt. *bīja*

self-conceit (我慢) Skt. *ātma-māna*

self-nature (自性) Skt. *svabhāva*

self-view (我見) Skt. *ātma-dṛṣṭi*

selflessness of persons (人無我) Skt. *pudgala-nairātmya*

sense faculties: The sense perceptions that correspond to the six sense organs (eyes, ears, nose, tongue, body, and mind): visual, auditory, olfactory, gustatory, tactile, and mental perceptions. [BDK BDK T0262]

sensual desire (欲貪) Skt. *kāmacchanda*

seven stations of consciousness (七識住) Skt. *saptavijñānasthiti*

shame (慚) Skt. *hrī*

signlessness (無相) Skt. *animitta*

six consciousnesses (六識) Skt. *ṣaḍ vijñāna*

six contacts (六觸) Skt. *ṣaṭ sparśa*

six sense bases (六入) Skt. *ṣaḍāyatana*

six supernatural powers (六神通) Skt. *ṣaḍabhijñā*

six supernormal faculties Skt. *sadabhijna*: Six supernormal powers consisting of the five supernormal faculties plus the ability to eradicate defilements. [BDK BDK T0159]

sloth-and-torpor (昏沉睡眠) Skt. *styāna-middha*

sphere of boundless consciousness (識無邊處) Skt. *vijñānānantyāyatana*

sphere of boundless space (空無邊處) Skt. *ākāśānantyāyatana*

sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception (非想非非想處) Skt. *naivasaṃjñānāsaṃjñāyatana*

sphere of nothingness (無所有處) Skt. *ākiñcanyāyatana*

sramanera: A Buddhist novice monk. [BDK BDK T0203]

sramanyaphala: Fruition of a sramana. [BDK BDK T0203]

srotapatti: The state of a stream enterer. [BDK BDK T0203]

srotāpanna (須陀洹)

srotāpatti (須陀洹果)

sudra: A member of the serf class, the lowest of the four castes. [BDK BDK T0159]

suffering (苦) Skt. *duḥkha*

supernatural powers (神通) Skt. *abhijñā*

sustained thought (伺) Skt. *vicāra*

sūtra (經)

tala: A type of palm tree. [BDK BDK T0203]

ten powers (十力) Skt. *daśabala*

ten wholesome deeds (十善業) Skt. *daśakuśalakarmapatha*

three characteristics (三法印) Skt. *trilakṣaṇa*

three emptinesses: See three liberations. [BDK BDK T0159]

three fetters (三結) Skt. *trīṇi saṃyojanāni*

Three Jewels (三寶) Skt. *triratna*

three poisons (三毒) Skt. *triviṣa*: Three basic mental afflictions: (1) desire or greed, (2) hatred or anger, and (3) ignorance or delusion. [BDK BDK T0159]

three refuges (三歸依) Skt. *triśaraṇa*

tongue-consciousness (舌識) Skt. *jihvā-vijñāna*

torpor (惛沉) Skt. *styāna*

Tripitaka: Three Baskets, an early collection of Buddhist texts. [BDK BDK T0203]

Tripiṭaka (三藏)

truth of cessation (滅諦) Skt. *nirodha-satya*

truth of suffering (苦諦) Skt. *duḥkha-satya*

truth of the origin (集諦) Skt. *samudaya-satya*

truth of the path (道諦) Skt. *mārga-satya*

twelve divisions of scripture (十二部經) Skt. *dvādaśāṅga-pravacana*

twelve links (十二因緣) Skt. *dvādaśāṅga-pratītyasamutpāda*

two truths (二諦) Skt. *dvisatya*

twofold selflessness (二無我) Skt. *dvi-nairātmya*

udāna (自說)

ultimate truth (勝義諦) Skt. *paramārtha-satya*

unconditioned (無為) Skt. *asaṃskṛta*

upadeśa (論議)

upasaka: A Buddhist layman. [BDK BDK T0203]

upasika: A Buddhist laywoman. [BDK BDK T0203]

utpala: A blue lotus. [BDK BDK T0203]

vaidurya: Lapis lazuli. [BDK BDK T0203]

vaipulya (方廣)

vaisya: A member of the class of peasants, merchants, and artisans, the third of the four castes. [BDK BDK T0159]

vexation (惱) Skt. *pradāśa*

view of the self-collection (身見) Skt. *satkāya-dṛṣṭi*

Vinaya (律) Skt. *vinaya*: A body of monastic rules. [BDK BDK T0203]

wisdom eye (慧眼) Skt. *prajñācakṣus*

wishlessness (無願) Skt. *apraṇihita*

wrath (忿) Skt. *krodha*

wrong view (邪見) Skt. *mithyā-dṛṣṭi*

Yogacara: A Buddhist school, founded in the fourth century C.E., which advocated the doctrine of ”mind only” or ”conscious construction only.” [BDK BDK T0676]

yojana: A league; a unit of distance. [BDK BDK T0203]

Āgama (阿含)

ālaya-vijñāna (阿賴耶識)

āsrava (漏)

āyatana (處)

Practices and Attainments (88 entries)

almsround (乞食) Skt. *piṇḍapāta*

anagamin: Non-returner; one who need not be reborn on this earth; one who is in the third of the four stages of development. [BDK BDK T0203]

aspiration (欲) Skt. *chanda*

attention (作意) Skt. *manaskāra*

bhavanamarga: Path of development, cultivation, or meditation. [BDK BDK T0203]

brahmacarya (梵行): Brahma conduct; the religious life; celibacy. [BDK BDK T0203]

compassion (悲) Skt. *karuṇā*

concentration (定) Skt. *samādhi*

consecration (灌頂) Skt. *abhiṣeka*

dhataguna: An ascetic practice, such as dwelling in the forest. [BDK BDK T0203]

dhuta: Ascetic practices, of which generally twelve are listed in the Mahayana. [BDK BDK T0159]

dhyana: Meditation or contemplation. [BDK BDK T0159]

dhyāna-pāramitā (禪定波羅蜜)

dhāraṇī (陀羅尼)

disenchantment (厭離) Skt. *nirveda*

dāna (布施)

dāna-pāramitā (布施波羅蜜)

eight liberations (八解脫) Skt. *aṣṭavimokṣa*: Eight kinds of meditation for attaining liberation from mental afflictions. [BDK BDK T0159]

eightfold path (八正道) Skt. *aṣṭāṅgika-mārga*

eightfold right path: See four noble truths. [BDK BDK T0211]

emptiness samādhi (空三昧) Skt. *śūnyatā-samādhi*

equanimity (捨) Skt. *upekṣā*

faith (信) Skt. *śraddhā*

five destinies: An alternative term for the five paths. [BDK BDK T0159]

five faculties (五根) Skt. *pañcendriyāṇi*

five powers (五力) Skt. *pañcabalāni*

four bases of supernatural power (四如意足) Skt. *catvāra ṛddhipādāḥ*

four dhyānas (四禪) Skt. *catvāri dhyānāni*

four formless absorptions (四無色定) Skt. *caturārūpyadhyāna*

four foundations of mindfulness (四念處) Skt. *catvāri smṛtyupasthānāni*

four immeasurables (四無量心) Skt. *catvāry apramāṇāni*: Four virtuous states of mind, regarded as immeasurable because they focus on all beings and can produce infinite merits: (1) loving-kindness, (2) compassion, (3) sympathetic joy, and (4) equanimity. [BDK BDK T0159]

four right efforts (四正勤) Skt. *catvāri samyakpradhānāni*

four stages of development: Sotapanna (q.v.), sakrdagamin (q.v.), anagamin (q.v.), arhat (q.v.). [BDK BDK T0203]

great compassion (大悲) Skt. *mahākaruṇā*

heedfulness (不放逸) Skt. *apramāda*

jhāna (禪) Skt. *dhyāna*

kalala: An embryo in a certain stage of development. [BDK BDK T0203]

kṣānti (忍辱)

kṣānti-pāramitā (忍辱波羅蜜)

lion's roar (獅子吼) Skt. *siṃhanāda*: A metaphor for great eloquence in teaching the Dharma. [BDK BDK T0262]

loving-kindness (慈) Skt. *maitrī*

mantra (真言)

meditation (禪定) Skt. *dhyāna*

mindfulness (念) Skt. *smṛti*

mindfulness of the Buddha (念佛) Skt. *buddhānusmṛti*

mindfulness of the Dharma (念法) Skt. *dharmānusmṛti*

mindfulness of the Saṅgha (念僧) Skt. *saṃghānusmṛti*

non-retrogression (不退轉) Skt. *avaivartika*

paramita: See six perfections. [BDK BDK T0159]

patient endurance (忍) Skt. *kṣānti*

Poṣadha (布薩) Skt. *poṣadha*

prajna: Transcendental, liberative wisdom; one of the six perfections. [BDK BDK T0262]

resolve (勝解) Skt. *adhimokṣa*

right action (正業) Skt. *samyak-karmānta*

right concentration (正定) Skt. *samyak-samādhi*

right effort (正精進) Skt. *samyag-vyāyāma*

right intention (正思惟) Skt. *samyak-saṃkalpa*

right livelihood (正命) Skt. *samyag-ājīva*

right mindfulness (正念) Skt. *samyak-smṛti*

right speech (正語) Skt. *samyag-vāc*

sakrdagamin: One who will be born only once more; one who is in the second of the four stages of development. [BDK BDK T0203]

samadhi: Meditation, concentration, (mental) one-pointedness. [BDK BDK T0203]

samādhi (三摩地)

seven factors of awakening (七覺支) Skt. *saptabodhyaṅga*

signless samādhi (無相三昧) Skt. *animitta-samādhi*

six destinies: An alternative term for the six paths. [BDK BDK T0159]

six perfections (六度) Skt. *ṣaṭpāramitā*: The perfection (paramita) of six qualities practiced by the bodhisattva on the way to complete enlightenment: (1) giving or generosity (dana), (2) morality or keeping the precepts (sila), (3) forbearance or patience (ksanti), (4) effort (virya), (5) meditation (dhyana), and (6) wisdom (prajna). [BDK BDK T0159]

six pāramitās (六波羅蜜) Skt. *ṣaṭpāramitā*

srotapanna: Stream enterer; one who is in the first of the four stages of development. [BDK BDK T0203]

stream-enterer Skt. *srota-apanna*: One who has entered the stream of the undefiled Noble Path and is on the way to enlightenment. [BDK BDK T0211]

sympathetic joy (喜) Skt. *muditā*

thirty-seven factors of awakening (三十七道品) Skt. *saptatriṃśad bodhipakṣyadharmāḥ*

thirty-seven factors of bodhi Skt. *saptatrimsad bodhipaksika dharmah*: A scheme of thirty-seven practices conducive to enlightenment divided into seven groups: (1) four fields of mindfulness, (2) four right exertions, (3) four bases of supernormal power, (4) five faculties, (5) five powers, (6) seven limbs of enlightenment, and (7) the noble eightfold path. [BDK BDK T0159]

three attainments: A reference to three of the six supernormal faculties: (1) the ability to know former lives; (2) supernormal vision, especially insight into the future destiny of all beings; and (3) the ability to eradicate defilements in the present. [BDK BDK T0159]

three hindrances Skt. *avaranataya*: Three obstacles to practice caused by (1) karma, (2) mental afflictions, and (3) retribution for past deeds. [BDK BDK T0159]

three liberations Skt. *vimoksatraya*: Three kinds of meditation regarded as gateways to liberation and known also as the three emptinesses: (1) meditation on emptiness, (2) meditation on signlessness, and (3) meditation on wishlessness. [BDK BDK T0159]

three sets of pure precepts Skt. *trividhani silani*: A threefold categorization of moral behavior: (1) precepts of restraint, pertaining to discipline and deportment; (2) precepts for accumulating wholesome qualities; and (3) precepts for bringing benefit to beings. [BDK BDK T0159]

tranquility (輕安) Skt. *praśrabdhi*

True Dharma: The first of the three ages of the Buddhist Dharma, in which the Buddhist teaching is properly practiced and enlightenment can be attained. [BDK BDK T0262]

two hindrances Skt. *avaranadvaya*: Two kinds of obstructions to practice: (1) afflictive hindrances caused by mental afflictions and (2) cognitive hindrances due to fundamental misapprehensions about the nature of reality. [BDK BDK T0159]

upadhyaya: A teacher of rules. [BDK BDK T0203]

vajra (金剛): A diamond and, by extension, anything hard and indestructible; a ritual implement shaped like a bolt and having one, three, or five prongs at each end. [BDK BDK T0159]

volition (思) Skt. *cetanā*

vīrya (精進)

vīrya-pāramitā (精進波羅蜜)

wisdom (慧) Skt. *prajñā*

wishless samādhi (無願三昧) Skt. *apraṇihita-samādhi*

śīla (戒)

Cosmological Terms (38 entries)

Akaniṣṭha (色究竟天)

animal realm (畜生) Skt. *tiryagyoni*

asura (阿修羅): A class of superhuman beings who are in constant conflict with the gods. [BDK BDK T0676]

Atapa (無熱天)

Avṛha (無煩天)

Bhadra kalpa (賢劫) Skt. *bhadrakalpa*

Brahmā heaven (梵天) Skt. *Brahmaloka*

Cāturmahārājakāyika (四大王眾天)

desire realm (欲界) Skt. *kāmadhātu*

devaputra (天子): Lit., ”son (putra) of a god (deva),” but often used synonymously with deva (god). [BDK BDK T0159]

eight prohibitions: (1) Not to kill, (2) not to steal, (3) not to engage in sexual acts, (4) not to lie, (5) not to drink liquor, (6) not to use high or broad beds, (7) not to put perfumes or oils on the body nor to sing or dance, and (8) to eat only at designated times. [BDK BDK T0211]

eight sufferings Skt. *astaduhkha*: (1) birth, (2) old age, (3) sickness, (4) death, (5) the suffering of being separated from those whom one loves, (6) the suffering of associating with those whom one dislikes, (7) the suffering of not getting what one wants, and (8) the suffering inherent in the five aggregates. [BDK BDK T0159]

five Pure Abodes (五淨居天) Skt. *pañca śuddhāvāsa*

five turbidities (五濁) Skt. *pañcakaṣāya*

form realm (色界) Skt. *rūpadhātu*

formless realm (無色界) Skt. *ārūpyadhātu*

gandharva (乾闥婆): A class of mythical beings, celestial musicians. [BDK BDK T0676]

hell (地獄) Skt. *naraka*

hungry ghost (餓鬼) Skt. *preta*: A kind of ghost that always suffers from hunger and thirst. [BDK BDK T0676]

kalpa (劫): An aeon. [BDK BDK T0203]

koṭi (億)

maṇḍala (曼荼羅)

Namo: Homage (to). [BDK BDK T0203]

Nirmāṇarati (化樂天)

nirvana: Liberation from the cycle of birth and death, a state in which all passions are extinguished and the highest wisdom (prajna) attained; bodhi, enlightenment. [BDK BDK T0262]

nāga (龍)

Paranirmitavaśavartin (他化自在天)

saṃsāra (輪迴)

Sudarśana (善現天)

Sudṛśa (善見天)

three evil paths (三惡道) Skt. *trayo durgati*

three realms (三界) Skt. *trailokya*: Three spheres of transmigratory existence: (1) the realm of desire, i.e., the world of everyday consciousness accompanied by desires; (2) the realm of form, in which desires have been eliminated but the physical body remains; and (3) the realm of nonform, in which the physical body no longer exists. [BDK BDK T0159]

trichiliocosm (三千大千世界) Skt. *trisāhasramahāsāhasralokadhātu*

Trāyastriṃśa (忉利天)

Tuṣita (兜率天)

twelvefold conditions: The twelvefold cycle of causes and conditions that make up the human condition, namely: (1) ignorance, (2) volitional activity, (3) consciousness, (4) name and form, (5) the six senses, (6) contact, (7) experience, (8) passion, (9) attachment, (10) existence, (11) rebirth, and (12) decay and death. [BDK BDK T0676]

yakṣa (夜叉)

Yāma (夜摩天)

Personal Names (154 entries)

Ajātaśatru (阿闍世)

Ambapālī (菴婆女) Skt. *Āmrapālī*

Amoghadarśin (不空見)

Anāthapiṇḍada (給孤獨)

Anīkṣipta (阿泥翅)

apasmāraka: A class of demonic beings. [BDK BDK T0262]

aranyaka bhiksu: A forest-dwelling monk. [BDK BDK T0203]

Aruṇa (阿樓那)

Asaṅga (無著)

Avalokitesvara: The name of a great bodhisattva who represents great compassion. [BDK BDK T0262]

Avalokiteśvara (觀自在)

Bandhumatī (般頭摩底)

Bandhumā (般頭摩) Skt. *Bandhumat*

bhadrakalpa: The Good Kalpa, in which a thousand Buddhas will appear. [BDK BDK T0203]

Bhadrapāla (跋陀和)

Bhagavan: The Buddha; the Lord. [BDK BDK T0203]

Bhagavat: A venerable teacher; an epithet of a buddha. [BDK BDK T0262]

bhiksu: A Buddhist monk. [BDK BDK T0203]

Bhāviveka (清辯)

Bimbisāra (頻婆娑羅)

Brahma gods: Supreme class of gods. [BDK BDK T0203]

Brahma Heaven: The heaven in which the Brahma gods live. [BDK BDK T0203]

Brahmā (梵天)

Buddha (佛)

buddha land: A cosmic world or realm in which a particular buddha dwells. [BDK BDK T0262]

buddhahood: The state of becoming or being a buddha; the goal of the bodhisattva path. [BDK BDK T0262]

Buddhajiva (佛陀什) Skt. *Buddhajīva*

Decadent Dharma: The last of the three ages of the Dharma, following the age of the Semblance Dharma, in which only the teaching of the Buddha exists but correct practice is no longer possible. [BDK BDK T0262]

deva: A class of supernatural beings; a god or divine being. [BDK BDK T0262]

Devadatta: A cousin of the Buddha who became his disciple but later tried to murder him and assume leadership of the sangha. [BDK BDK T0262]

Dharma body Skt. *dharmakaya*: The manifestation of the Buddha as ultimate reality. [BDK BDK T0262]

Dharmarakṣa (竺法護)

Dhṛtarāṣṭra (持國天王)

eight difficult conditions: Eight conditions under which it is difficult to encounter a Buddha: (1) in the hells, (2) as hungry ghosts, (3) as animals, (4) in Uttarakuru (the northern continent where all is pleasant), (5) in the long-life heavens (where life is long and easy), (6) as deaf, blind, and dumb, (7) as a worldly philosopher, (8) in the intermediate period between a Buddha and his successor. [BDK BDK T0203]

eight difficulties Skt. *astaksana*: Eight places or circumstances where one is unable to see the Buddha or listen to the Dharma: (1) hell, (2) the realm of hungry ghosts, (3) the realm of animals, (4) the heavens of long life, (5) the border regions, (6) the state of having impaired sense organs, (7) the state of having erroneous views, and (8) the land where a tathagata has not appeared. [BDK BDK T0159]

eight great fears Skt. *astamahabhaya*: Usually, (1) lions, (2) elephants, (3) fire, (4) snakes, (5) thieves, (6) violent waters, (7) imprisonment, and (8) demons. [BDK BDK T0159]

eight inopportune births: The eight births that prevent one from seeing a Buddha or hearing the Dharma are (1) birth in hell; (2) birth in the realm of hungry spirits; (3) birth in the realm of beasts; (4) birth in the heaven of long life, where aspiration to enter the Buddhist Path does not arise; (5) birth in a remote land, in one of the heavens of the realms of form and formlessness or in Uttarakuru, one of the four continents in Buddhist cosmology, where sentient beings are absorbed in pleasures and do not seek the Dharma; (6) being born blind, deaf, or mute; (7) being knowledgeable about the world and eloquent; and (8) being born in a period before or after the Buddha's appearance in the world. [BDK BDK T0211]

five paths Skt. *pancagati*: Five states of transmigratory existence: (1) hell, (2) hungry ghosts (pretas), (3) animals, (4) humans, and (5) gods (devas). [BDK BDK T0159]

five skandhas Skt. *skandha*: The five elements of form, feeling, conception, mental process, and consciousness which comprise the personality and give rise to the mistaken view of a permanent, inherent self. [BDK BDK T0262]

four demons Skt. *caturmara*: Four causes of suffering and obstacles to practice: (1) mental afflictions, (2) the five aggregates, (3) death, and (4) the king of demons (Papiyas) in Paranirmitavasavartin Heaven. [BDK BDK T0159]

four groups of practitioners Skt. *catusparisad*: Four categories of Buddhist followers: (1) monks, (2) nuns, (3) laymen, and (4) laywomen. [BDK BDK T0159]

four holy truths: (1) Life is intrinsically full of suffering; (2) our attachments are the cause of suffering; (3) all suffering can be ended; (4) the way to end suffering is by following the Buddha's eightfold path (i.e., right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right concentration). [BDK BDK T0676]

Fātian (法天)

Gautama (瞿曇)

great vehicle: A form of Buddhism that appeared in India around 100 B.C.E. and which exalts as its religious ideal the bodhisattva, the great being who thoroughly grasps the doctrine of emptiness and is willing to delay his own enlightenment until he can save all sentient beings. Otherwise known as the Mahayana. [BDK BDK T0676]

Guṇabhadra (求那跋陀羅)

Hinayana: A derogatory term applied by Mahayanists to the various schools of Buddhism that exalt as their ideal the arhat, the religious adept who has transcended all passions. [BDK BDK T0676]

jataka: A story of a previous life of the Buddha. [BDK BDK T0203]

Kanakamuni (拘那含牟尼)

Kang Senghui (康僧會)

kasaya: A red or yellow monk's robe. [BDK BDK T0203]

Kauśika (憍尸迦)

Kauṇḍinya (憍陳如)

King Bimbisāra (頻婆娑羅王) Skt. *Bimbisāra*

Krakucchanda (拘留孫)

kumbhanda: A class of demonic beings. [BDK BDK T0262]

Kumārajīva (鳩摩羅什)

Kāśyapa (迦葉)

Kāśyapa Buddha (迦葉佛) Skt. *Kāśyapa*

Kṛkī (汲毘)

mahallaka: An aged monk. [BDK BDK T0203]

mahasattva: A great bodhisattva. [BDK BDK T0159]

Mahayana: A form of Buddhism that developed in India around 100 B.C.E. and exalts as its religious ideal the bodhisattva. [BDK BDK T0159]

Mahesvara: A certain god; often Siva. [BDK BDK T0203]

Mahādṛḍha (大堅固)

Mahāmaudgalyāyana (大目犍連)

Mahāmāyā (摩耶夫人)

Mahāsubhūti (大須菩提)

Mahāvairocana (大毘盧遮那)

Maitreya (彌勒): The future Buddha, currently still a bodhisattva. [BDK BDK T0262]

Manjusri: The bodhisattva who represents great wisdom. [BDK BDK T0262]

Mara: The Evil One; the Devil. [BDK BDK T0203]

Maudgalyāyana (目犍連)

Mañjuśrī (文殊師利)

Māra (魔)

Māra Pāpīyas (魔波旬)

Māravimardaka (摧魔)

Nandika (難提迦)

Nigrodha (尼拘陀)

Nāgārjuna (龍樹)

Nārada (那羅陀)

pisaca: A kind of demon. [BDK BDK T0203]

Piṇḍola-bhāradvāja (賓頭盧跋羅墮闍) Skt. *Piṇḍola Bhāradvāja*

Prabhākaramitra (波羅頗蜜多羅)

Prabhāvatī (光明)

Prasenajit (波斯匿王)

putana: A class of demonic beings that cause disease in children. [BDK BDK T0262]

Rahu: The demon that causes eclipses. [BDK BDK T0203]

raksasa: A kind of demon. [BDK BDK T0203]

Ratnākara (寶積)

Reṇu (大典尊)

Rāhula (羅睺羅)

Sakra devanam indra: Sakra, the lord of the gods (of a certain level). [BDK BDK T0203]

Sakyamuni: The historical Buddha, who lived in India in the fifth century B.C.E. and whose life and teachings form the basis for Buddhism. [BDK BDK T0262]

Sakyas Skt. *Sakya*: The name of the historical Buddha Sakyamuni's family clan. [BDK BDK T0262]

Samantabhadra (普賢)

Sambuddha: One who is completely awake; a Buddha. [BDK BDK T0203]

Samyaksambuddha: One who is truly and completely awakened; a Buddha. [BDK BDK T0203]

Sarvadatta (薩婆達)

Saṃghabhūti (僧伽跋澄)

Semblance Dharma: The second of the three ages of the Buddhist Dharma, following the age of the True Dharma, in which the Buddha's teaching is practiced but enlightenment is no longer possible. [BDK BDK T0262]

seven precious things: Seven kinds of precious metals and gems, variously listed in different sources. Also, seven precious things said to be possessed by a wheel-turning king (cakravartin): (1) a wheel, (2) a precious jewel, (3) a queen, (4) a minister, (5) an elephant, (6) a general, and (7) a horse. [BDK BDK T0159]

single vehicle Skt. *ekayana*: The one buddha vehicle, the Mahayana teaching espoused in the Lotus Sutra that leads to complete enlightenment and attainment of buddhahood, contrasted with the teachings of the two Hinayana vehicles. The single vehicle includes and transcends all three vehicles of the sravaka, pratyekabuddha, and bodhisattva paths. [BDK BDK T0262]

six paths Skt. *sadgati*: Six states of transmigratory existence: (1) hell, (2) hungry ghosts (pretas), (3) animals, (4) demigods (asuras), (5) humans, and (6) gods (devas). [BDK BDK T0159]

six realms of existence: (1) The realm of the gods, (2) the realm of humans, (3) the realm of fighting demons, (4) the realm of animals, (5) the realm of hungry ghosts, and (6) hell. All beings transmigrate through these realms in the cycle of birth and death in accordance with their karma. [BDK BDK T0211]

six recollections Skt. *sadanusmrti*: Six kinds of mindfulness directed at (1) the Buddha, (2) the Dharma, (3) the Sangha, (4) morality, (5) charity, and (6) divinities. [BDK BDK T0159]

skillful means Skt. *upaya*: The various methods and means used by buddhas and bodhisattvas to guide and teach sentient beings, adapted to their different capacities. [BDK BDK T0262]

solitary enlightened one: A solitary Buddha who had no teacher, does not teach, and lacks universal compassion. [BDK BDK T0676]

sramana: An ascetic. [BDK BDK T0203]

sravaka: Originally, a disciple of the historical Buddha, one who directly heard his teachings. Later used as a general term for followers of early Buddhism, to distinguish them from adherents of Mahayana and Tantric Buddhism. [BDK BDK T0159]

stupa: A tope; a structure in which the relics of a buddha are placed. [BDK BDK T0262]

Subhūti (須菩提)

sudha: Nectar, the beverage of the gods. [BDK BDK T0203]

Sudinna (須提那)

Sudāna (須達拏)

Sugata: Literally, ”he who has attained happiness” (or ”he who has gone well”); a designation for a buddha. [BDK BDK T0159]

Supratīta (善淨)

sutra: A Buddhist scripture, a discourse of the Buddha. [BDK BDK T0262]

Sūryaprabha (日光)

Tathagata: Literally, ”he who has thus gone (or come)”; a designation for a buddha. [BDK BDK T0159]

Three Treasures: The Buddha, the Dharma (Doctrine), and the Sangha (Order). [BDK BDK T0203]

three vehicles: The paths of the sravakas, pratyekabuddhas, and bodhisattvas, respectively. [BDK BDK T0262]

triple refuge: The Buddha, the Dharma (the Buddha's teachings), and the Sangha (the community of his followers). [BDK BDK T0211]

two vehicles: The two Hinayana paths of sravakas and pratyekabuddhas. [BDK BDK T0262]

universal monarch Skt. *cakravartin*: The ideal king, as conceived of in Indian philosophy. [BDK BDK T0262]

Uttarā (優多羅)

Vaiśravaṇa (毘沙門)

Vajramuṣṭi (金剛拳)

Vajrapāṇi (金剛手)

Vajrasattva (金剛薩埵)

Varuṇadatta (水天授)

Varṣakāra (禹舍)

Vasubhadra (婆素跋陀)

vetala: A reanimated corpse-demon. [BDK BDK T0203]

Vipaśyin (毘婆尸)

Virūpākṣa (廣目天王)

Virūḍhaka (增長天王)

Viśvabhū (毘舍浮)

Viśākhā (毘舍佉)

wheel-turning sage-king Skt. *cakravartin*: An ideal universal monarch whose power derives from a wheel obtained at the time of his enthronement; four kinds of cakravartins are distinguished according to the basic element from which his wheel is made (gold, silver, copper, or iron). [BDK BDK T0159]

word-hearers Skt. *sravakas*: Originally, personal disciples of Sakyamuni who heard his teachings; later generally used to mean so-called Hinayana Buddhists. [BDK BDK T0676]

Xuanzang (玄奘)

yaksa: A class of demonic beings; human flesh-eaters. [BDK BDK T0676]

yaksakrtya: A class of demonic sorcerers. [BDK BDK T0262]

Ākāśagarbha (虛空藏)

Ākāśasaṃbhava (虛空生)

Ānanda (阿難)

Śakra (帝釋)

Śakra Devānām-Indra (帝釋天) Skt. *Śakra Devānām Indra*

Śikhin (尸棄)

Śuddhodana (淨飯王)

Śākyamuni (釋迦牟尼)

Śākyamuni Buddha (釋迦牟尼佛)

Śāriputra (舍利弗)

Place Names (55 entries)

akimcanyayatana: The stage of samadhi (q.v.) in which nothing exists; the third stage of the four stages of the formless world. [BDK BDK T0203]

aranya: Wilderness or forest, regarded as the ideal place to engage in the practices of a renunciant. [BDK BDK T0159]

aranyaka: Pertaining to the forest; a forest-dweller; a forested place. [BDK BDK T0203]

Aruṇavatī (阿樓那跋提)

Avanti (阿盤提)

Aṅga (鴦伽)

Bamboo Grove (竹林精舍) Skt. *Veṇuvana*

birth and death Skt. *samsara*: Samsara; the round of rebirth. [BDK BDK T0203]

Brahma: First of the gods of the Brahma class. [BDK BDK T0203]

brahman: The priestly caste in the Indian caste system; in the Lotus Sutra the term also applies to a class of heavenly beings. [BDK BDK T0262]

Campā (瞻波)

Ganges (恒河) Skt. *Gaṅgā*

Gṛdhrakūṭa (耆闍崛山)

Hiraṇyavatī (希連禪河)

Jambudvipa: A mythological continent south of Mount Sumeru, q.v. [BDK BDK T0203]

Jambudvīpa (閻浮提)

Jeta's Grove (祇樹) Skt. *Jetavana*

Jetavana (祇園)

Kalandaka Bamboo Grove (迦蘭陀竹園) Skt. *Kalandakanivāpa Veṇuvana*

Kamboja (劍浮沙)

Kapilavastu (迦毘羅衛)

Kosala (拘薩羅)

Koṭigāma (拘利村)

Kuru (拘樓)

Kuśinagara (拘尸那)

Kāśī (迦尸)

Magadha (摩揭陀)

Mahotpala Hell: Great Lotus Hell. [BDK BDK T0203]

Mallā (末羅)

Mithilā (彌稀羅)

Mount Gṛdhrakūṭa (靈鷲山) Skt. *Gṛdhrakūṭa*

Mount Sumeru (須彌山) Skt. *Sumeru*: In Buddhist cosmology, the highest mountain rising from the center of the world, surrounded by an ocean in which the four continents that comprise the world of human beings are situated. [BDK BDK T0262]

non-returner Skt. *anagamin*: One who has reached a stage of spiritual quest that frees one from rebirth in the kamadhatu, the world of desire. Such a person is not yet an arhat, and is bound to be born in the upper samsaric world, i.e., in the rupadhatu and arupyadhatu. Though a non-returner does return to the world, ordinary mortals in the world of desire do not see this return. [BDK BDK T0676]

Nādikā (那提迦)

once-returner Skt. *sakrdagamin*: The second of the four stages of spiritual attainment in the Hinayana; one who has attained this state is subject to rebirth only once in each of the three realms of the triple world before attaining nirvana. [BDK BDK T0262]

Pañcāla (般闍羅)

Pāṭaligāma (巴吒釐村)

Pāṭaliputra (華氏城)

Pāṭalī (波吒釐)

Rājagṛha (王舍城)

saha world Skt. *saha*: The world of endurance, suffering. [BDK BDK T0262]

Sahā (娑婆)

Sahā world (娑婆世界) Skt. *Sahā*

Sumeru: A mythological mountain, the axis of the world. [BDK BDK T0203]

Sārandada Shrine (沙然陀) Skt. *Sārandada*

three evil destinies Skt. *tryapaya*: Three of the six states of transmigratory existence in which sentient beings transmigrate in retribution for evil deeds: (1) hell, (2) hungry ghosts, and (3) animals. [BDK BDK T0159]

three unwholesome destinations: The hells, hungry ghosts, animals. [BDK BDK T0203]

three woeful destinations: The three evil realms in which sentient beings transmigrate as retribution for evil deeds, namely, (1) hell, (2) the realm of hungry ghosts, and (3) the realm of animals. [BDK BDK T0211]

Trayastrimsa Heaven Skt. *Trayastrimsa*: Heaven of Sakra. [BDK BDK T0203]

triple world: The three realms of samsaric existence in which living beings transmigrate as a result of their karma: 1) the realm of desire (kamadhatu), i.e., the world of ordinary consciousness accompanied by desires; the realm of form (rupadhatu), in which desires have been eliminated but the physical body remains; and the formless realm (arupyadhatu), in which the physical body no longer exists. [BDK BDK T0262]

Uttarakuru (北俱盧洲)

Vaiśālī (毘舍離)

Videha (毘提訶)

Vārāṇasī (波羅奈)

Śrāvastī (舍衛)

Titles and Honorifics (25 entries)

arhat (阿羅漢): One who is in the last of the four stages of development. [BDK BDK T0203]

arhatship (阿羅漢果) Skt. *arhat*

bhikṣu (比丘)

bhikṣuṇī (比丘尼)

Blessed One (世尊) Skt. *Bhagavān*

bodhisattva (菩薩): A being on the way to awakening. [BDK BDK T0203]

bodhisattva-mahāsattva (菩薩摩訶薩)

cakravartin (轉輪王): The Wheel-turning King; universal monarch. [BDK BDK T0203]

dharma king (法王) Skt. *dharmarāja*

Great Vajra-Holder (大金剛手) Skt. *Mahāvajradhara*

Knower of the World (世間解) Skt. *Lokavid*

Perfectly Enlightened (正等覺) Skt. *Samyaksaṃbuddha*

pratyekabuddha (辟支佛): A solitary Buddha; one who neither teaches nor is taught. [BDK BDK T0203]

Tamer of Men (調御丈夫) Skt. *Puruṣadamyasārathi*

Tathāgata (如來)

Teacher of Gods and Humans (天人師) Skt. *Śāstā devamanuṣyāṇām*

Tripiṭaka Master (三藏法師) Skt. *Tripiṭaka*

Unsurpassed (無上士) Skt. *Anuttara*

upāsaka (優婆塞)

upāsikā (優婆夷)

Well-Gone (善逝) Skt. *Sugata*

Worthy One (應供) Skt. *Arhat*

ācārya (阿闍梨)

śramaṇa (沙門)

śrāvaka (聲聞)

Monastic Items (13 entries)

alms bowl (鉢) Skt. *pātra*

five precepts (五戒) Skt. *pañcaśīla*: The five precepts for Buddhist laypeople: (1) Not to kill, (2) not to steal, (3) not to commit adultery, (4) not to lie, and (5) not to use intoxicants. [BDK BDK T0211]

four assemblies (四眾) Skt. *catuḥpariṣad*

kāṣāya (袈裟)

ordination (受具足戒) Skt. *upasampadā*

parajika (波羅夷) Skt. *pārājika*

precepts (戒) Skt. *śīla*

Prātimokṣa (波羅提木叉)

rains retreat (安居) Skt. *varṣā*

saṃghāṭī (僧伽梨)

Saṅgha (僧伽) Skt. *saṃgha*

stūpa (塔)

uttarāsaṅga (鬱多羅僧)

Other Terms (18 entries)

amṛta (甘露)

Aśvattha tree (阿說他樹) Skt. *aśvattha*

Bodhi tree (菩提樹) Skt. *bodhivṛkṣa*: The tree under which the Buddha attained awakening in meditation. [BDK BDK T0203]

brāhmaṇa (婆羅門)

Dharmaguptaka (法藏部): A certain school of Buddhism. [BDK BDK T0203]

four elements (四大) Skt. *catvāri mahābhūtāni*

kṣatriya (刹帝利)

Licchavī (離車)

Mahisasaka (彌沙塞部) Skt. *Mahīśāsaka*

maṇi (摩尼)

Nyagrodha tree (尼拘陀樹) Skt. *nyagrodha*

Puṇḍarīka tree (芬陀利樹) Skt. *Puṇḍarīka*

Pāṭalī tree (波吒釐樹) Skt. *Pāṭalī*

Udumbara tree (優曇婆羅樹) Skt. *udumbara*

Vedas (吠陀) Skt. *Veda*

Vṛjji (跋耆)

Śirīṣa tree (尸利沙樹) Skt. *śirīṣa*

Śāla tree (娑羅樹) Skt. *śāla*